SecureScan AI: Target Authorization & Scope Enforcement Manual

User Guide: How to Add Targets, Resolve Scope Blocks, and Scan Safely • **Author:** Vinod Kumar

1. Understanding the 'Scan Blocked (HTTP 403)' Safety Mechanism

When launching a scan, users may encounter an error message such as:

Scan Blocked (HTTP 403): Unauthorized: Requested URL host 'xyz.com' does not match authorized target domain 'localhost'.

Why did this happen?
In SecureScan AI, security testing is strictly restricted to domains for which documented authorization or verified ownership has been established. If the user selects Target #1 (e.g. localhost:5001) in the 'Select Authorized Target' dropdown, but enters an external URL (e.g. https://weather-app-a7f3.onrender.com/ or https://bank-client.com) into the URL field, the backend **Scope Enforcer** immediately blocks the request to prevent illegal out-of-scope testing.

2. Step-by-Step: How to Scan Any Target Domain

To scan any web target safely without being blocked, follow these simple steps:

Step 1 — Register Target: Navigate to the **Authorized Targets** tab (#targets) in the left sidebar menu.

Step 2 — Add Details: Click the **+ Add New Target** button. Enter the domain name (e.g. weather-app-a7f3.onrender.com).

Step 3 — Choose Authorization Type:
• **Educational / Lab Environment:** Instant automatic approval for test websites, university sandbox targets, and demo labs.
• **Own Website (DNS TXT / HTML Meta):** Proves domain ownership by checking a generated token on the web server or DNS.
• **Third-Party Client (Written Authorization):** Uploads signed penetration testing authorization agreements with defined testing windows.

Step 4 — Launch Scan: Go to the **New Scan** tab. In the **Select Authorized Target** dropdown, choose the target you registered (e.g. weather-app-a7f3.onrender.com (LAB - VERIFIED)). The starting URL will automatically match! Click **Launch Authorized Assessment**.

3. Pre-Approved Quick Testing Targets Available Right Now

The following targets are pre-configured in SecureScan AI and can be scanned immediately:

Target Selection in Dropdown	Matching Target Starting URL	Testing Purpose
weather-app-a7f3.onrender.com (VERIFIED)	https://weather-app-a7f3.onrender.com/	Live cloud web app on Render
localhost:5001 (LAB - VERIFIED)	http://localhost:5001/lab/test-page	Local built-in educational sandbox
testphp.vulnweb.com (LAB - VERIFIED)	http://testphp.vulnweb.com	Acunetix public practice test application
bank-client.com (THIRD_PARTY - APPROVED)	https://bank-client.com	Simulated corporate third-party portal